

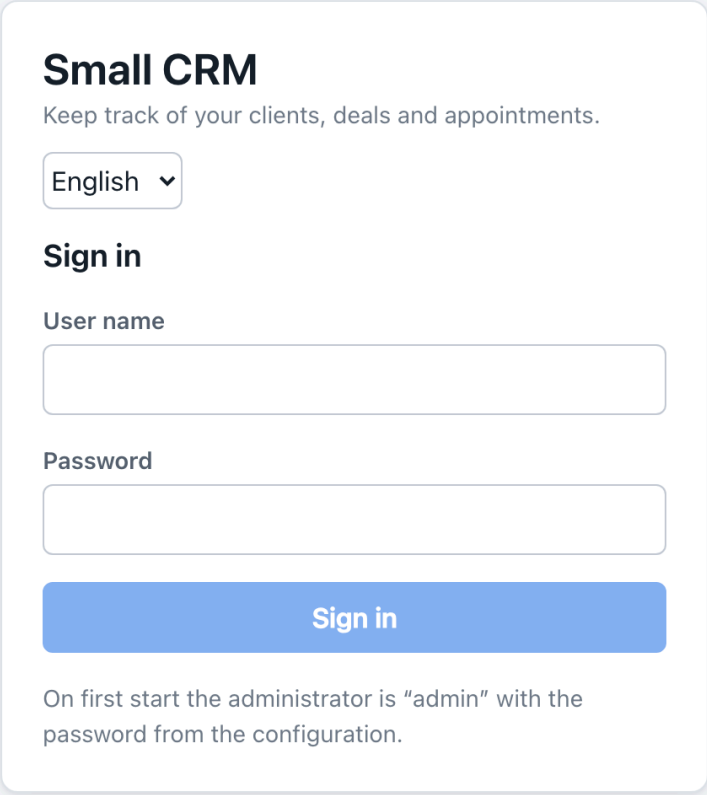
Small CRM — user manual

Small CRM keeps track of the people you do business with, what you have agreed, what you still owe them and when you are meeting them. This manual walks through every screen. It takes about ten minutes to read.

Everything is stored on your own computer, in a single file. There is no account to create anywhere and nothing is sent to anyone.

1. Starting for the first time

Open `http://localhost:8080` in your browser. You are asked to sign in. The very first time, the user name is `admin` and the password is the one set in the configuration — `changeit` unless somebody changed it for you.

The image shows a web browser window displaying the 'Small CRM' sign-in page. The page has a light blue background. In the center, there is a white rounded rectangle containing the sign-in form. At the top of this rectangle, the text 'Small CRM' is displayed in bold, followed by the tagline 'Keep track of your clients, deals and appointments.' Below this, there is a language selection dropdown menu currently set to 'English'. Underneath the dropdown, the heading 'Sign in' is shown. This is followed by two input fields: 'User name' and 'Password'. Below the password field is a blue 'Sign in' button. At the bottom of the white rectangle, a note states: 'On first start the administrator is "admin" with the password from the configuration.'

The sign-in screen. The language can be switched here too, before you sign in.

Small CRM immediately asks you to choose your own password. This cannot be skipped, and that is deliberate: the starting password is written in a configuration file that other people may be able to read.

Choose a new password

Your password has to be changed before you can continue. Pick something only you know, at least 8 characters long.

Current password

New password

Repeat new password

Change password

Pick something only you know, at least eight characters long.

If you forget your password

Another administrator can set a new one for you on the Users screen. If you are the only administrator, ask whoever installed Small CRM for help.

2. Finding your way around

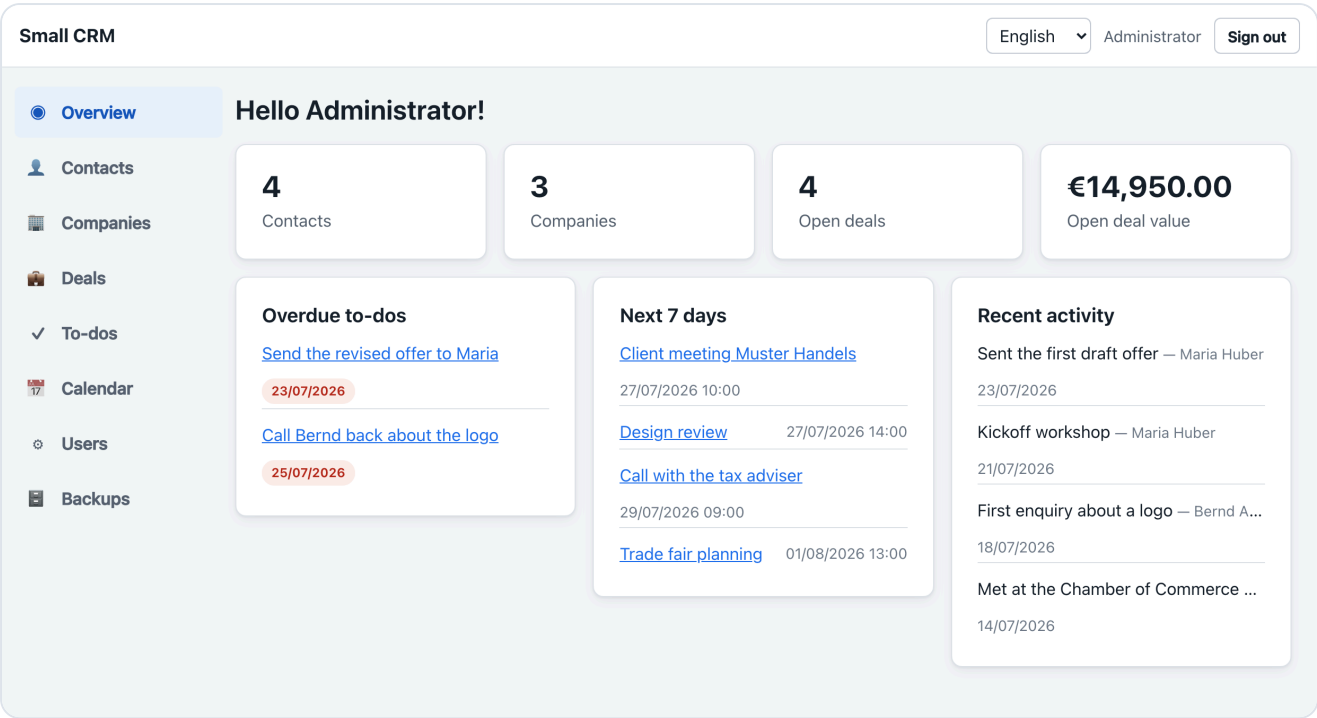
Every screen has the same frame:

- The bar along the top shows the name of the application, the language, who is signed in, and the **Sign out** button.
- The list down the left is the main menu. **Users** and **Backups** only appear if you are an administrator.
- Everything else is the screen you are on.

Three habits carry across the whole application. A blue button is the one that saves. Anything that deletes is outlined in red and always asks first. And nothing is saved until you press **Save** — closing a dialog with **Cancel** throws the edit away.

3. The overview

The overview is the first thing you see after signing in. It is meant to answer one question: what needs me today?



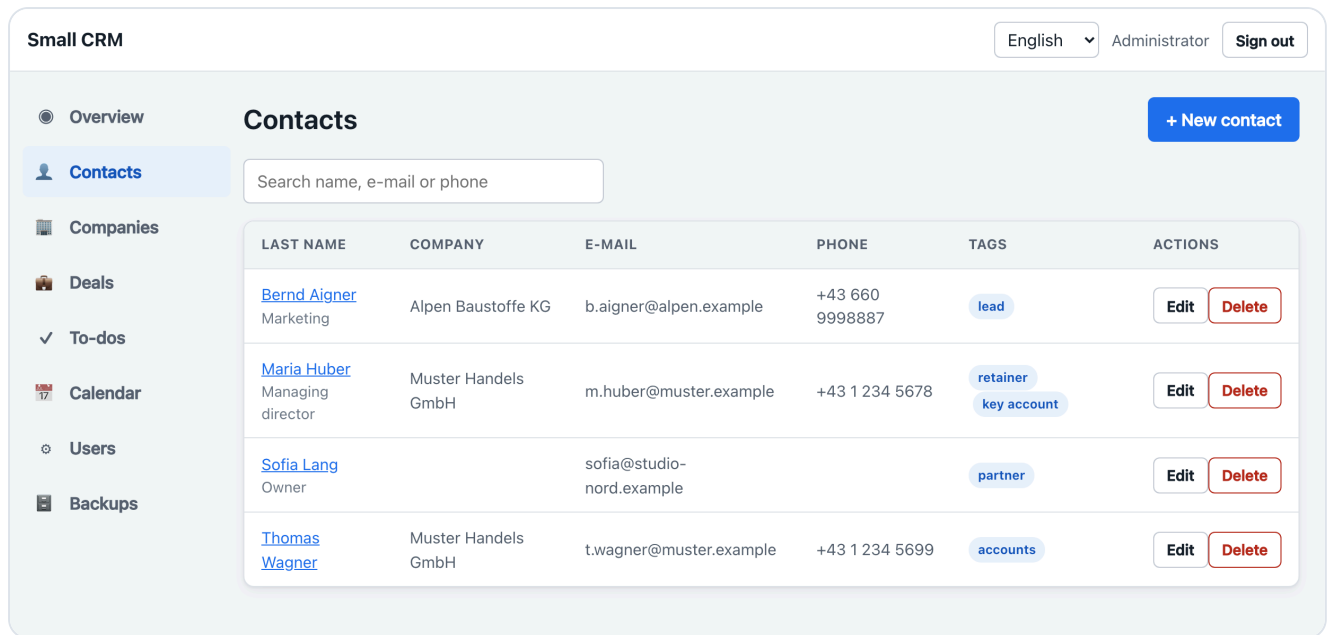
The overview after a few weeks of use.

PART	WHAT IT SHOWS
The four tiles	How many contacts and companies you have, how many deals are still open, and what they are worth in total. Each tile is a link to the matching screen.
Overdue to-dos	Anything whose due date has passed and is not ticked off. The red date is how long it has been waiting.
Due today	To-dos due today, so they do not become overdue.
Next 7 days	Your appointments for the coming week.
Recent activity	The last things you logged: calls, e-mails, meetings and notes.

When there is nothing overdue and nothing due today, those two panels disappear and a green line says so instead. An empty overview is good news.

4. Contacts

A contact is a person. Contacts are the centre of Small CRM: deals, to-dos, appointments and logged activity all hang off them.



Small CRM

English Administrator Sign out

Overview

Contacts

+ New contact

Search name, e-mail or phone

LAST NAME	COMPANY	E-MAIL	PHONE	TAGS	ACTIONS
Bernd Aigner Marketing	Alpen Baustoffe KG	b.aigner@alpen.example	+43 660 9998887	lead	Edit Delete
Maria Huber Managing director	Muster Handels GmbH	m.huber@muster.example	+43 1 234 5678	retainer key account	Edit Delete
Sofia Lang Owner		sofia@studio-nord.example		partner	Edit Delete
Thomas Wagner	Muster Handels GmbH	t.wagner@muster.example	+43 1 234 5699	accounts	Edit Delete

The contact list, sorted by surname.

Adding someone

1. Press **+ New contact**.
2. First and last name are required; everything else is optional.
3. Pick a company if the person works for one. If the company is not in the list yet, add it on the Companies screen first.
4. Press **Save**.

Small CRM

English Administrator Sign out

Overview

Contacts

+ New contact

Search

LAST NAME

Bernd A...

Marketing

Maria Hu...

Managing director

Sofia Lan...

Owner

Thomas Wagner

ACTIONS

Edit Delete

Edit Delete

Edit Delete

Edit Delete

New contact

First name * Last name *

E-mail Phone

Mobile Role

Company Tags

None

Separate several tags with a comma.

Notes

Cancel Save

Fields marked with * have to be filled in. The rest can wait.

Tags

Tags are your own labels — *key account*, *lead*, *pays late*, whatever is useful to you. Type several separated by commas. They show up in the list so you can spot a group at a glance.

Searching

The search box above the list looks through names, e-mail addresses and phone numbers. Type a few letters and the list narrows as you go; clear the box to see everyone again.

One contact in detail

Click a name to open that person's page. It gathers everything you know about them in one place.

Small CRM

English

Administrator

Sign out

Overview

Contacts

Companies

Deals

To-dos

Calendar

Users

Backups

← Contacts

Maria Huber

Managing director · Muster Handels GmbH

Contact

E-mail

m.huber@muster.example

Phone

+43 1 234 5678

Mobile

+43 664 1112223

retainer

key account

Prefers e-mail. Signs off on anything above 5.000 EUR herself.

Activity

+ New

Email

Sent the first draft offer

23/07/2026, 16:20

x

Meeting

Kickoff workshop

Agreed on scope, three templates, launch before the trade fair.

21/07/2026, 10:00

x

Deals

Website relaunch

Proposal sent

€8,400.00

Monthly maintenance

Qualified

€2,400.00

To-dos

Send the revised offer to Maria

23/07/2026

Maria's page: her details, what has happened, what is being sold and what is still to do.

The **Activity** panel is the diary of your relationship. Press **+ New**, choose whether it was a call, an e-mail, a meeting or just a note, give it a subject, and add as much detail as you like. Next time this person rings, you can see what you last agreed.

Activities are for what already happened

You cannot log an activity with a date in the future — that is almost always a typo. Use the calendar for things that are still to come.

Deleting a contact

Deleting a person also deletes their activity history, because an activity without a person means nothing. Their deals, to-dos and appointments are kept and simply lose the link. You are asked to confirm, and the prompt names the person.

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5. Companies

A company is an organisation. Use it when you deal with several people at the same firm, or when you need the billing address and VAT number in one place.

Small CRM

English Administrator Sign out

Overview

Contacts

Companies

Deals

To-dos

Calendar

Users

Backups

Companies

+ New company

Search name or city

NAME	CITY	E-MAIL	PHONE	ACTIONS
Alpen Baustoffe KG	Innsbruck	kontakt@alpen.example		Edit Delete
Muster Handels GmbH	Vienna	office@muster.example	+43 1 234 5678	Edit Delete
Studio Nord	Hamburg			Edit Delete

Companies. Search covers the name and the city.

You do not have to use companies at all. A contact without one works perfectly well, which suits one-person clients.

Deleting a company keeps its people

Contacts and deals that belonged to it stay exactly where they are and simply lose the link to the company. Nothing disappears behind your back.

6. Deals

A deal is a piece of work you hope to be paid for. The screen shows one column per stage, so you can see at a glance what is where.

The pipeline. Each column heading shows how many deals it holds and what they add up to.

STAGE	MEANS
Lead	Somebody showed interest. Nothing has been promised.
Qualified	You have talked, it is real, and they can afford it.
Proposal sent	Your offer is with them and you are waiting.
Won	They said yes.
Lost	They said no, or it went quiet for good.

To move a deal along, use the dropdown on its card and pick the new stage. There is no dragging: a dropdown says exactly where the card is going and works on a touch screen.

Open only is ticked by default, which hides won and lost deals so the pipeline shows only what still needs work. Untick it to see everything, including your history.

7. To-dos

To-dos are the small promises that are easy to forget: send the offer, chase the invoice, call back on Thursday.

Small CRM

English Administrator Sign out

Overview

Contacts

Companies

Deals

✓ To-dos

Calendar

Users

Backups

To-dos

☒ Open only

☐ **Send the revised offer to Maria**
She asked for the shop connection to be split out separately.
Overdue 23/07/2026 **High** · Maria Huber · Website relaunch Edit Delete

☐ **Call Bernd back about the logo**
Overdue 25/07/2026 **Normal** · Bernd Aigner Edit Delete

☐ **Prepare the quarterly VAT filing**
03/08/2026 **Low** Edit Delete

To-dos, earliest due date first. Anything overdue is marked in red.

- Tick the box on the left to mark something done. It disappears from the list straight away, because **Open only** is on.
- Untick **Open only** to see what you have finished, and to tick something back open if you were too quick.
- Link a to-do to a contact or a deal, and it also shows up on that contact's page.
- To-dos without a due date sit at the bottom. They are for "some day", not for today.

8. Calendar

The calendar is a simple agenda: your appointments grouped by day, earliest first. Use the buttons at the top to look 7, 30 or 90 days ahead.

Small CRM

English Administrator Sign out

Overview

Contacts

Companies

Deals

To-dos

Calendar

Users

Backups

Calendar

+ New appointment

Show 7 days Show 30 days Show 90 days

Monday, 27 July 2026

10:00 **Client meeting Muster Handels** **Edit** **Delete**
11:30 90 min · Their office, Mariahilfer Strasse · Maria Huber

14:00 **Design review** **Edit** **Delete**
15:00 60 min · Bernd Aigner

Wednesday, 29 July 2026

09:00 **Call with the tax adviser** **Edit** **Delete**
10:00 60 min · Phone

Saturday, 1 August 2026

13:00 **Trade fair planning** **Edit** **Delete**
15:00 120 min · Online

The agenda. Each entry shows the time, how long it lasts, the place and the person.

The double-booking check

While you are filling in a new appointment, Small CRM checks the time against your calendar and tells you before you save. A green line means the slot is free. A yellow box means it clashes, and it names what with.

The warning appears as you type, not after you save.

If you try to save anyway, Small CRM refuses and explains why. You then have two choices: change the time, or press **Save anyway** to book both in parallel. That button only appears after a refusal, so a double booking is always something you chose rather than something you missed.

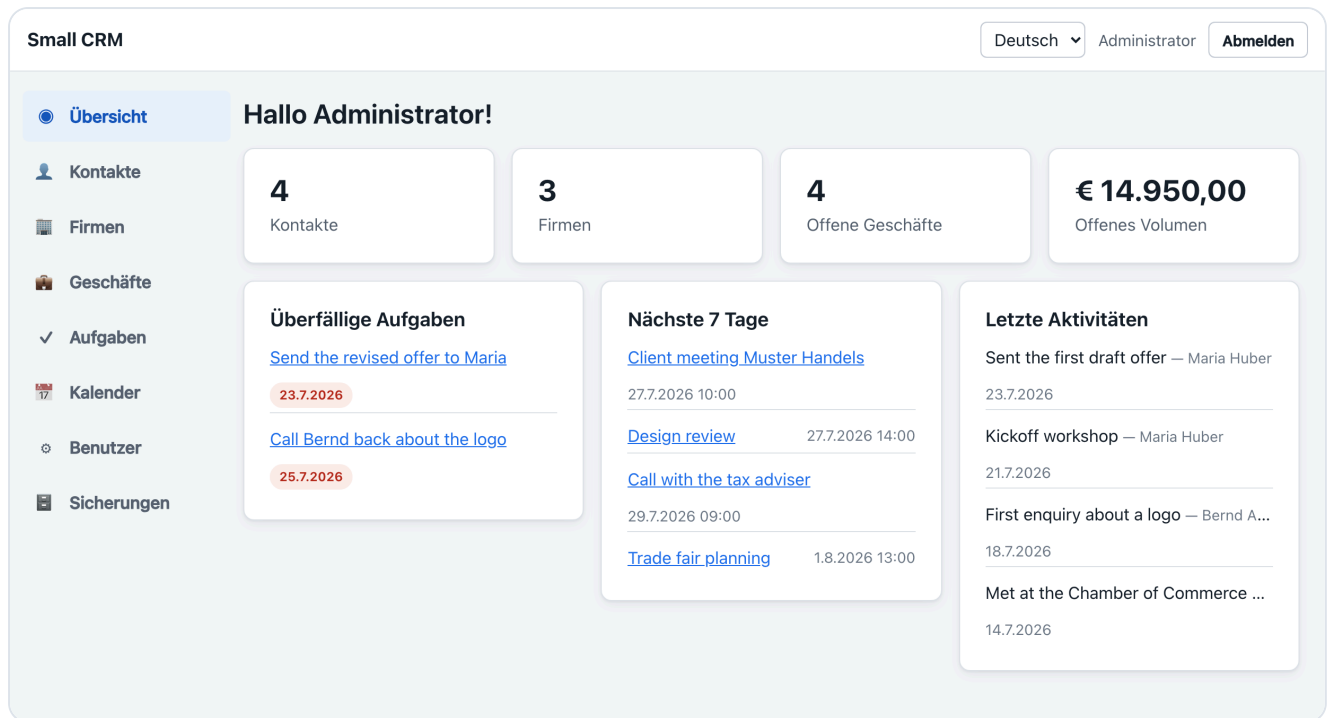
Back-to-back is fine

An appointment ending at 10:00 and another starting at 10:00 do not clash. Only real overlaps are flagged.

The check looks at *your* calendar only. If a colleague has something at the same time, that is their business, and you are not warned about it.

9. Switching language

Small CRM speaks English and German. The dropdown in the top bar switches between them immediately — no reload, and you do not lose what you were doing.



The same overview in German. Dates and amounts follow the language too.

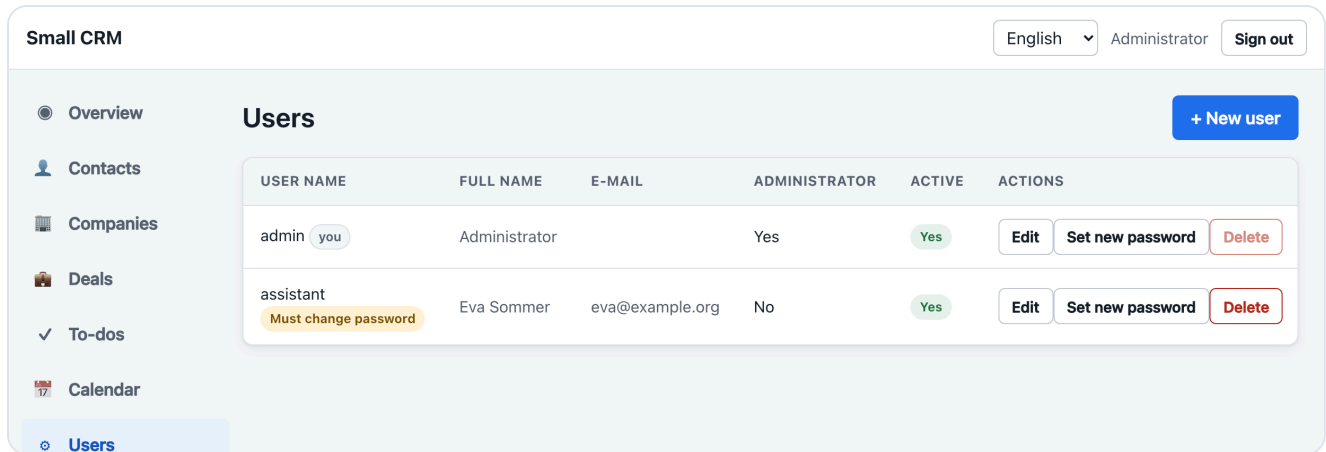
Your choice is remembered on that computer and applies to error messages as well, not just the labels. Dates change format (25/07/2026 against 25.7.2026) and so do amounts (€1,234.50 against € 1.234,50).

The little calendar and clock pop-ups

When you click a date or time field, the picker your browser shows follows your computer's language, not the one chosen here. That is how browsers work and cannot be changed from inside Small CRM.

10. Users

Administrators can give other people access — an assistant, a partner, your bookkeeper. Everyone shares the same data: there are no private contacts.



The screenshot shows the 'Users' management page in the Small CRM application. At the top, there's a header with 'Small CRM', a language dropdown set to 'English', the current user 'Administrator', and a 'Sign out' button. A left sidebar contains navigation links: Overview, Contacts, Companies, Deals, To-dos, and Calendar. The main area is titled 'Users' and features a '+ New user' button. Below this is a table with columns: USER NAME, FULL NAME, E-MAIL, ADMINISTRATOR, ACTIVE, and ACTIONS. The table lists two users: 'admin' (marked 'you') and 'assistant' (marked 'Must change password'). Each user row has 'Edit', 'Set new password', and 'Delete' buttons.

USER NAME	FULL NAME	E-MAIL	ADMINISTRATOR	ACTIVE	ACTIONS
admin you	Administrator		Yes	Yes	Edit Set new password Delete
assistant Must change password	Eva Sommer	eva@example.org	No	Yes	Edit Set new password Delete

Users. The badge shows who still has to choose their own password.

1. Press **+ New user**.
2. Give a user name and a starting password, and tell the person both.
3. Tick **Administrator** only if they should also manage users and backups.

The new person has to replace that starting password the first time they sign in, so it never becomes their real one. **Set new password** does the same thing again if somebody is locked out.

Somebody who has left should be set to inactive rather than deleted: they can no longer use Small CRM, but the records they created keep their name.

You cannot lock yourself out

Small CRM refuses to delete or deactivate your own account, and refuses to remove the last remaining administrator. There is always a way back in.

11. Backups

Small CRM backs itself up. Every time you change something, the whole of your data is written to an XML file in a `backup` folder next to the application. Changes made close together end up in one file, so a busy afternoon does not leave hundreds of copies behind.

Small CRM English Administrator Sign out

Backups Create backup now

Every change is saved to an XML file in the folder below. Older files are removed automatically after the retention period.

Folder: /tmp/crm-manual/backup

A backup contains your business data. User accounts and passwords are not included.

Keep backups for

14 days Save

Anything older is deleted automatically. Between 1 and 3650 days.

Restore from a file on your computer

Choose File No file chosen Upload and restore

Pick an XML file that was created by Small CRM.

Available backups

FILE	CREATED	SIZE	ACTIONS
smallcrm-backup-2026-07-25T22-53-04.xml	26/07/2026, 00:53	10 kB	Download Restore

Backup created. ✕

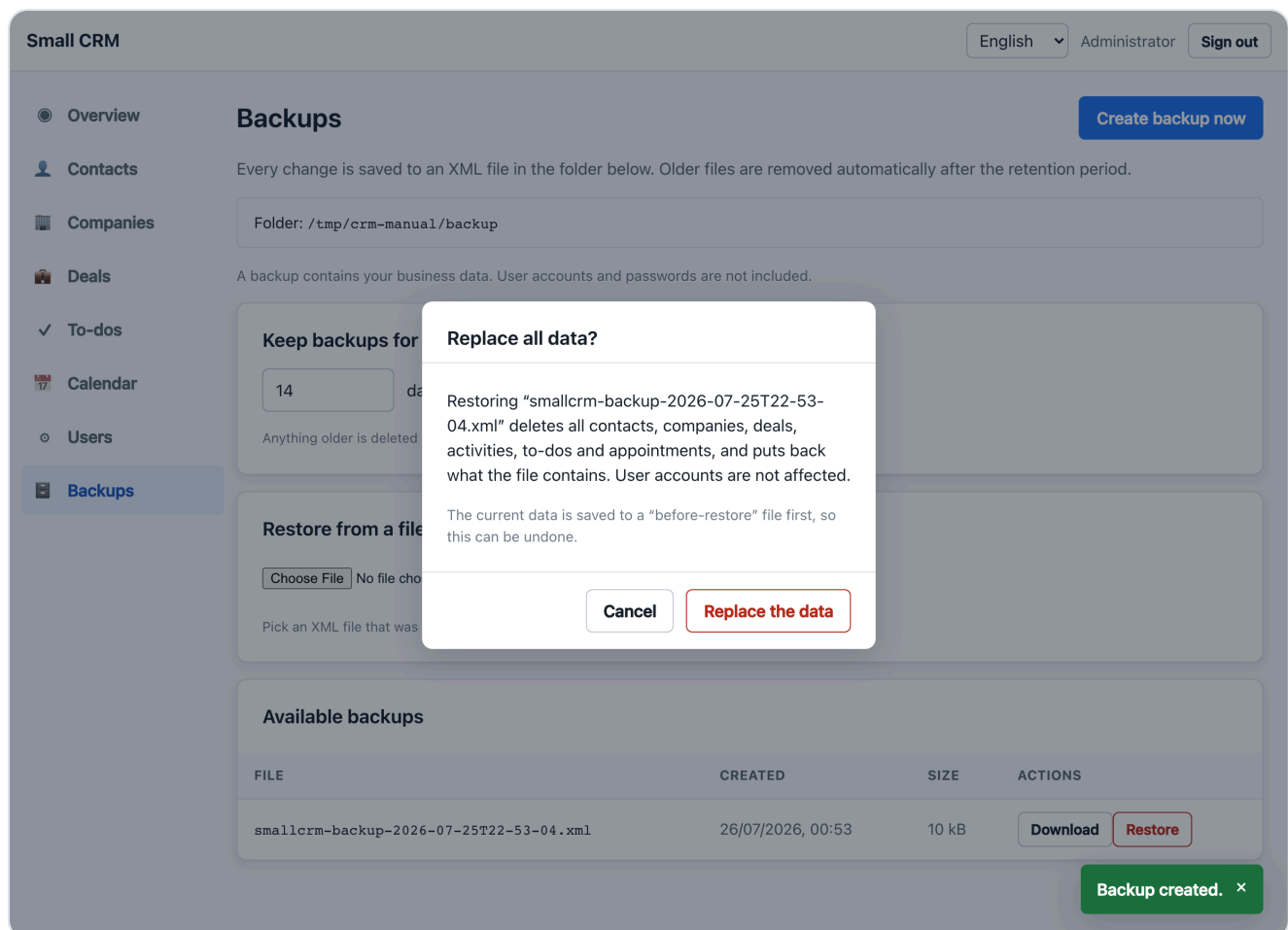
The Backup screen. The folder at the top is where the files live.

WHAT	DOES
Create backup now	Writes a file immediately. Useful before you try something risky.
Keep backups for ... days	How long files are kept. Fourteen days to start with. Anything older is removed automatically.
Download	Saves that file wherever you like — a USB stick, another computer, your cloud drive.
Restore	Puts the data from that file back, replacing what is there now.
Upload and restore	The same, from a file you saved elsewhere.

Restoring

A restore replaces everything

All contacts, companies, deals, activities, to-dos and appointments are deleted and replaced by what is in the file. Anything entered after that backup was taken is gone. User accounts are not affected.



The prompt names the file and spells out what happens. Nothing is touched until you confirm.

Before replacing anything, Small CRM saves the current state to a file starting with `before-restore-`. So if you restore the wrong file, you can restore that one and be back where you started. It appears at the top of the list with a yellow badge.

What is not in a backup

User accounts and passwords are deliberately left out, so a backup file can be handed to your accountant without giving away anyone's login. After restoring onto a brand new installation you will have your data but no users, and the records will not show who created them.

Keep a copy somewhere else

The backup folder sits next to your database on the same computer. That protects you from a mistaken deletion, but not from a lost, stolen or broken machine. Download a backup now and then and keep it elsewhere.

12. Common questions

Where is my data?

In a single file called `smallcrm.mv.db`, in the `data` folder next to the application, plus the XML files in `backup`. Copy those two folders and you have copied everything.

Can I use it on my phone?

The screens rearrange for a small display and the menu collapses behind the `≡` button. It is usable for looking things up. Longer editing is more comfortable on a computer.

I deleted something by mistake.

There is no undo button, but there is almost certainly a backup from a few minutes earlier. Go to Backups, find the file from before the mistake and restore it — bearing in mind that everything entered since then goes too. If in doubt, download the newest backup first so you have both versions.

Two of us want to work at the same time.

That works. Everyone sees the same contacts, deals and to-dos. The one thing to know is that if two people edit the same record at the same moment, the one who saves last wins, silently.

Does anything leave my computer?

No. Small CRM does not send data anywhere, has no cloud component and needs no internet connection to run.

Can I sync with Google Calendar?

Not yet. Appointments are stored with the fields such a synchronisation will need, so appointments you enter today will be picked up when it arrives.

Small CRM — user manual. The screenshots use made-up demo data. Licensed under the Apache License 2.0.